

Grow-well basics

The strongest foundations for baby’s brain and your wellbeing — alongside the games.

**Folate**
palak, methi, dals, rajma, oranges

**Choline & protein**
eggs, paneer, soya, peanuts, dal

**Iron + vitamin C**
ragi, poha, greens, dates + amla, lemon

**Calcium & B12**
milk, curd, til, paneer

**Omega-3 / DHA**
sardine, mackerel, walnuts, flaxseed

**Iodine & water**
iodised salt; 8–10 glasses a day

- Sleep 7–9 hours; from 28 weeks go to sleep on your side.
- Walk 20–30 minutes most days (as your doctor allows).
- Take the folic acid, iron and calcium your doctor prescribes.
- No alcohol or tobacco; under 200 mg caffeine a day; only boiled/pasteurised milk; fully cooked eggs and meat.



Call your doctor at once for bleeding, fluid leaking, baby moving less, severe headache or blurred vision, swelling of face/hands, fever, severe pain, or feeling unable to cope. Ambulance 108 · Tele-MANAS 14416.

Our belly-art photo

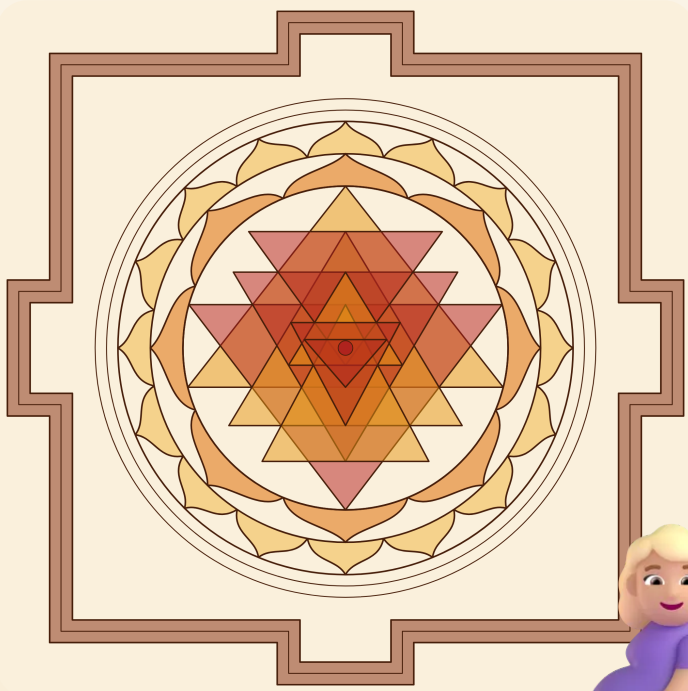
Sources: WHO 2016 & 2020; ACOG 2020; ICMR-NIN 2024; RCOG 2011; Partanen 2013; DeCasper 1986; Marx & Nagy 2015; Corrigan 2022. Images: Microsoft Fluent Emoji (MIT); Śrī Yantra from the sri-yantra package (MIT). For personal use; not medical advice.

A LITTLE BOOK TO DO AGAIN AND AGAIN

Garbha Khel

गर्भ खेल

12 joyful activities for mother & baby — play, paint, listen, repeat



This book belongs to _____

How to play

Twelve short activities — games, drawing, painting, music and stillness — each paired with music to play alongside and a spiritual touch. Every one is chosen to **calm you** and to give your baby **soothing sound, rhythm and touch**. Do one or two a day; repeat your favourites as often as you like. Tick a circle each time.

Mon	Mandala + Lullaby	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Tue	Kolam game + Humming bee	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Wed	Story with voices + Gratitude	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Thu	Śrī Yantra + Kick-and-tap	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Fri	Paint your feelings + Lullaby	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Sat	Name-that-raga + Moonlight sway	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐
Sun	Belly art (any week) + family choice	☐ ☐ ☐ ☐

- Science-backed
- Emerging evidence
- ◆ Tradition

● strong evidence (e.g. voice, singing, touch, nutrition, sleep) · ● promising studies, mostly for the mother’s calm (music, art, breathing) · ◆ tradition and spiritual practice, shared with respect.

Honest note: no activity makes a “genius” baby or decides looks or gender. What truly helps a baby’s growing brain is a well-nourished, rested, supported and calm mother — and the sound of loving voices. That is what these games give.

‡ Check with your doctor before new breathing or movement practices. Stop if you feel pain, dizziness, bleeding, fluid leakage or contractions.

Music & mantra card

Choose calm music (slow, steady beat) at a comfortable volume through room speakers. Never place headphones on the belly. Your own voice — singing, humming, chanting — is baby’s favourite sound.

Morning	Raga Bhairav / Ahir Bhairav · Venkatesa Suprabhatam (M.S. Subbulakshmi)
Afternoon	Raga Bhimpalasi · santoor ‘Call of the Valley’ (Shivkumar Sharma & Hariprasad Chaurasia)
Evening	Raga Yaman on bansuri · Raga Bhoopali · veena Raga Mohanam
Night	Raga Bageshri / Malkauns · your family lullaby · tanpura drone
Anytime	Om chanting · Bhaja Govindam · Kurai Ondrum Illai · nature sounds (rain, birds)

Four mantras to know by heart



Om — chant softly on a long out-breath.

ॐ भूर्भुवः स्वः । तत्सवितुर्वरेण्यं भर्गो देवस्य धीमहि । धियो यो नः प्रचोदयात् ॥

Gāyatrī — may the divine light brighten our minds.

असतो मा सद्गमय । तमसो मा ज्योतिर्गमय । मृत्योर्मा अमृतं गमय ॥

Lead me from untruth to truth, darkness to light, death to immortality.

सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः । सर्वे सन्तु निरामयाः ॥

May all be happy; may all be free from illness.

Secular choice: hum a favourite tune, or read a short poem slowly — the calm comes from the slow out-breath.



I2 Moonlight Sway

चन्द्र · Candra · moon



⌚ 10 min Any week **Emerging evidence** Repeat often

Night	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Moon shape								

1. Evening: put on slow music, hold your partner or a chair.
2. Sway side to side like a cradle — slow, small, smooth. No jumping or spinning.
3. End by looking at the moon and telling baby its shape tonight.

PLAY ALONGSIDE

Raga Bageshri or a slow garba; a cradle song (hālārādum)

SPIRITUAL TOUCH

दधिशङ्खतुषाराभं क्षीरोदारवसम्भवम्

dadhi-śaṅkha-tuṣārābhaṃ kṣīrodārava-sambhavam

White as curd, conch and snow, born of the milky ocean — salutations to the Moon. (Navagraha stotra)

For baby: Rhythmic rocking is how babies are soothed — baby already feels your gentle movement.

For you: Gentle movement eases the back, lifts mood and helps sleep.

MY NOTES · BABY'S RESPONSE

DONE ○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○

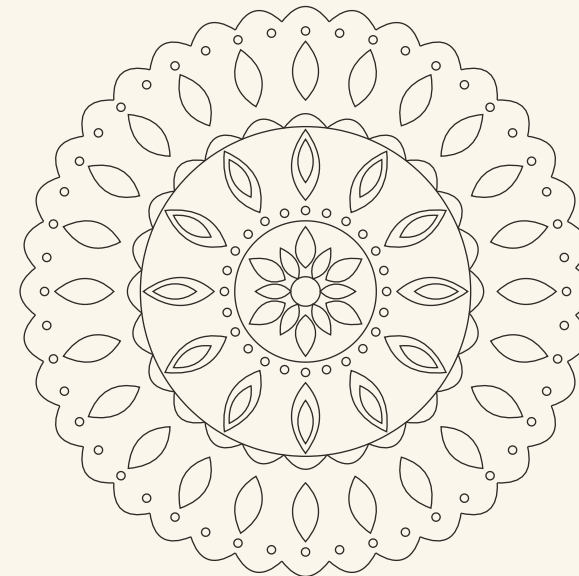
‡ Hold support; stop with pain, dizziness or contractions.

I Colour a Mandala

मण्डल · Maṇḍala



⌚ 20 min Any week **Emerging evidence** Repeat often



1. Put on the music. Pick 3 colours only.
2. Colour from the centre outwards, one ring per song.
3. Breathe slowly; tell baby which colour you chose.

PLAY ALONGSIDE

Raga Yaman on bansuri — Pt. Hariprasad Chaurasia (evening)

SPIRITUAL TOUCH

ॐ पूर्णमिदः पूर्णमिदम्

om pūrṇam adaḥ pūrṇam idam

That is whole, this is whole — you are whole, and so is your baby.

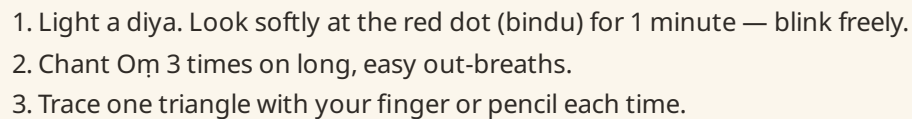
For baby: Calm music and your relaxed heartbeat and breathing reach baby; from ~19 weeks baby hears low tones.

For you: Focused, repetitive colouring lowered anxiety in studies; it rests the busy mind.

MY NOTES · BABY'S RESPONSE

DONE ○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○

श्री यन्त्र · Śrī Yantra



Tanpura drone, then silence

शुभं करोति कल्याणमारोग्यं धनसम्पदा

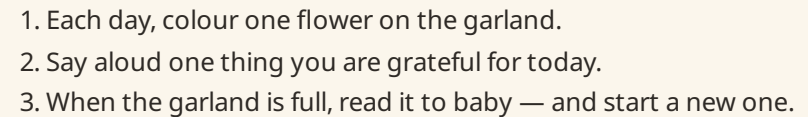
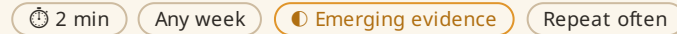
śubhaṃ karoti kalyāṇam ārogyaṃ dhanasampadā
The lamp's light brings goodness, wellbeing and health — I bow to that light.

For baby: Slow, humming exhalations calm your body; baby feels your steady rhythm.

For you: A single point of focus quiets racing thoughts — a traditional meditation aid.

DONE

‡ Keep the diya safe and away from fabric; never stare or strain.



'Bhaja Govindam' — M.S. Subbulakshmi

धियो यो नः प्रचोदयात्

dhiyo yo naḥ pracodayāt

May the divine light inspire our minds. (Gāyatrī
mantra, Ṛgveda 3.62.10)

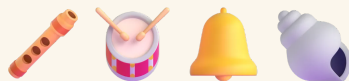
For baby: Positive mood in pregnancy is linked with calmer stress responses.

For you: Daily gratitude gives small, lasting boosts to wellbeing.

DONE

10 Name-That-Raga Game

नाद · Nāda · sound



⌚ 10 min From ~20 weeks 🕒 Emerging evidence Repeat often

Round	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Mother								
Partner								

1. Partner plays a 30-second clip — flute, veena, sitar, bells, conch, or a raga.
2. Guess the instrument or raga. 1 point each!
3. Keep score below. Winner chooses tonight's lullaby.

▶ PLAY ALONGSIDE

Mix: Bhairav (morning), Bhoopali, Desh, Yaman (evening), Malkauns (night)

♦ SPIRITUAL TOUCH

नादब्रह्म

nāda-brahma

Sound is the divine — music as a path to stillness.

For baby: Baby hears a rich variety of melodies and rhythms at a comfortable volume.

For you: A playful listening game: attention, memory and plenty of laughter.

MY NOTES · BABY'S RESPONSE

DONE ○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○

‡ Comfortable volume — never headphones on the belly.

3 Kolam Dot Game

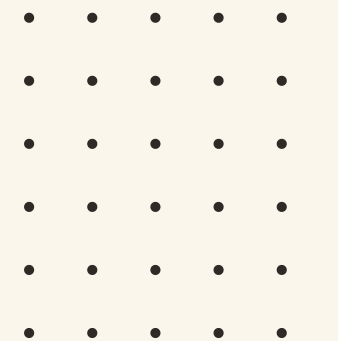
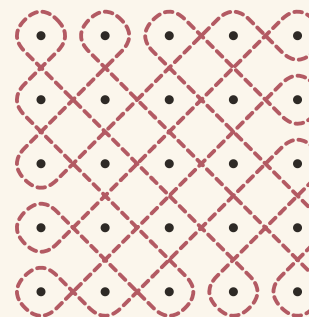
कोलम् · Kolam



⌚ 10 min Any week ♦ Tradition Repeat often

YOUR TURN

TRACE ME



1. Trace the sample loop with one unbroken line.
2. Game: on the empty grid, make your own loop without lifting the pencil.
3. Next time, try a bigger loop. Smile at every wobble.

▶ PLAY ALONGSIDE

Veena — Raga Mohanam (Carnatic)

♦ SPIRITUAL TOUCH

सर्वे भवन्तु सुखिनः

sarve bhavantu sukhinah

May all be happy. (Rice-flour kolams traditionally feed ants and birds — kindness to every being.)

For baby: Your relaxed, absorbed state means calmer stress hormones for both of you.

For you: A gentle puzzle for hand and eye — attention, patience and a small win every time.

MY NOTES · BABY'S RESPONSE

DONE ○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○

4 Kick-and-Tap Game

स्पर्श • Sparśa • touch



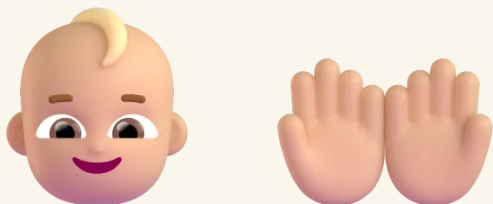
⌚ 10 min

From ~24 weeks

🕒 Emerging evidence

Repeat often

Day	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Kicks back								



1. Lie on your side when baby is active. Hands on your belly.
2. When baby kicks, gently tap or stroke that spot and say 'Hello!'
3. Wait. Did baby kick back? Tally the replies below — a game you share.

▶ PLAY ALONGSIDE

Your own humming of the family lullaby

♦ SPIRITUAL TOUCH

सह नाववतु । सह नौ भुनक्तु ।

saha nāv avatu / saha nau bhunaktu /
May we two be protected together; may we be
nourished together.

For baby: In a 4D-scan study, babies moved more when mothers stroked their belly — touch is baby's first language.

For you: Joyful connection; you learn your baby's pattern (call your doctor if movements slow down).

MY NOTES • BABY'S RESPONSE

DONE ○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○

‡ Gentle touch only. If baby moves less than usual, call your doctor now.

9 Humming Bee Breath

भ्रामरी • Bhrāmarī



⌚ 5 min

Any week

🕒 Emerging evidence

Repeat often



1. Sit tall. Touch thumb and index finger (Jñāna mudrā).
2. Breathe in through the nose; breathe out humming 'mmm' like a bee.
3. 7 rounds — never hold the breath. Then sit in silence for one minute.

▶ PLAY ALONGSIDE

Silence — then a temple bell or conch to finish

♦ SPIRITUAL TOUCH

स्थिरसुखमासनम्

sthira-sukham āsanam
Sit steady and comfortable. (Yoga Sūtra 2.46)

For baby: Humming vibration and slow breath settle your nervous system; baby hears the low hum.

For you: Long humming out-breaths shift the body towards 'rest and digest' (small studies).

MY NOTES • BABY'S RESPONSE

DONE ○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○

‡ Never hold the breath. Stop if dizzy.

Belly Art & Photo



Repeat often



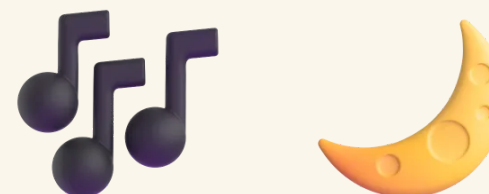
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10

One Lullaby, Every Night



Repeat often



- [illegible]

6 Story with Voices

कथा · Kathā



⌚ 10 min

From ~20 weeks

● Science-backed

Repeat often

The Monkey and the Crocodile (Pañcatantra). A kind monkey shared sweet rose-apples with his friend the crocodile every day. The crocodile's wife wanted the monkey's sweet heart, so the crocodile carried him across the river on his back — and confessed halfway. The monkey stayed calm: "My heart? I left it in my tree! Take me back and I'll fetch it." Back on the bank, he leapt to safety. *A calm mind finds a way, even in deep water.*

1. Read the mini-story aloud, with a monkey voice and a crocodile voice.
2. Game: retell it from memory next time — add one new detail.
3. Ask: 'What would you do, little one?'

▶ PLAY ALONGSIDE

No music — your voice is the music

◆ SPIRITUAL TOUCH

वसुधैव कुटुम्बकम्

vasudhaiva kuṭumbakam

The whole world is one family. (Hitopadeśa / Mahā Upaniṣad)

For baby: Your voice is the clearest sound in the womb; newborns recognise stories read to them often (DeCasper 1986).

For you: Playful voices and recall keep your mind lively and lighten the mood.

MY NOTES · BABY'S RESPONSE

DONE ○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○

7 Paint Your Feelings

रङ्ग · Raṅga · colour



⌚ 20 min

Any week

● Emerging evidence

Repeat often

today's feeling · date ____

1. Close your eyes: what colour is today's feeling?
2. Paint or finger-paint it in the frame — shapes, swirls, no rules.
3. Add one bright colour for a wish for baby. Date it.

▶ PLAY ALONGSIDE

Santoor — 'Call of the Valley', Pt. Shivkumar Sharma

◆ SPIRITUAL TOUCH

तमसो मा ज्योतिर्गमय

tamaso mā jyotir gamaya

Lead me from darkness to light.

For baby: Releasing worries lowers your stress — the environment baby grows in.

For you: Art-making reduces stress in many studies; naming feelings softens them.

MY NOTES · BABY'S RESPONSE

DONE ○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○○